

**From
Truth**

**to
Transformation**

**Insights
From the
EEX**



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Who Are We?

27

Countries

1300+

Talents

400+

Awards



What Is The EEX 2025?

135 Clients

63 Agency Leaders

27 Agencies/Countries

7 Regions

By NewtonX (Independent Research Firm)

WE UNCOVERED
THE TRUTH
LAST YEAR.

IT CHANGED THE
CONVERSATION.

The Great Marketing Mirage

KPI GAP – The Need vs. Reality

Are We Really Fluent in AI and New Tech?

What Clients Really Want

The Sustainability Reality Check

The Pitch Paradox

**WE SWEAR KPIS ARE
OUR NORTH STAR...
BUT THE COMPASS IS
OFTEN *MISSING*.**

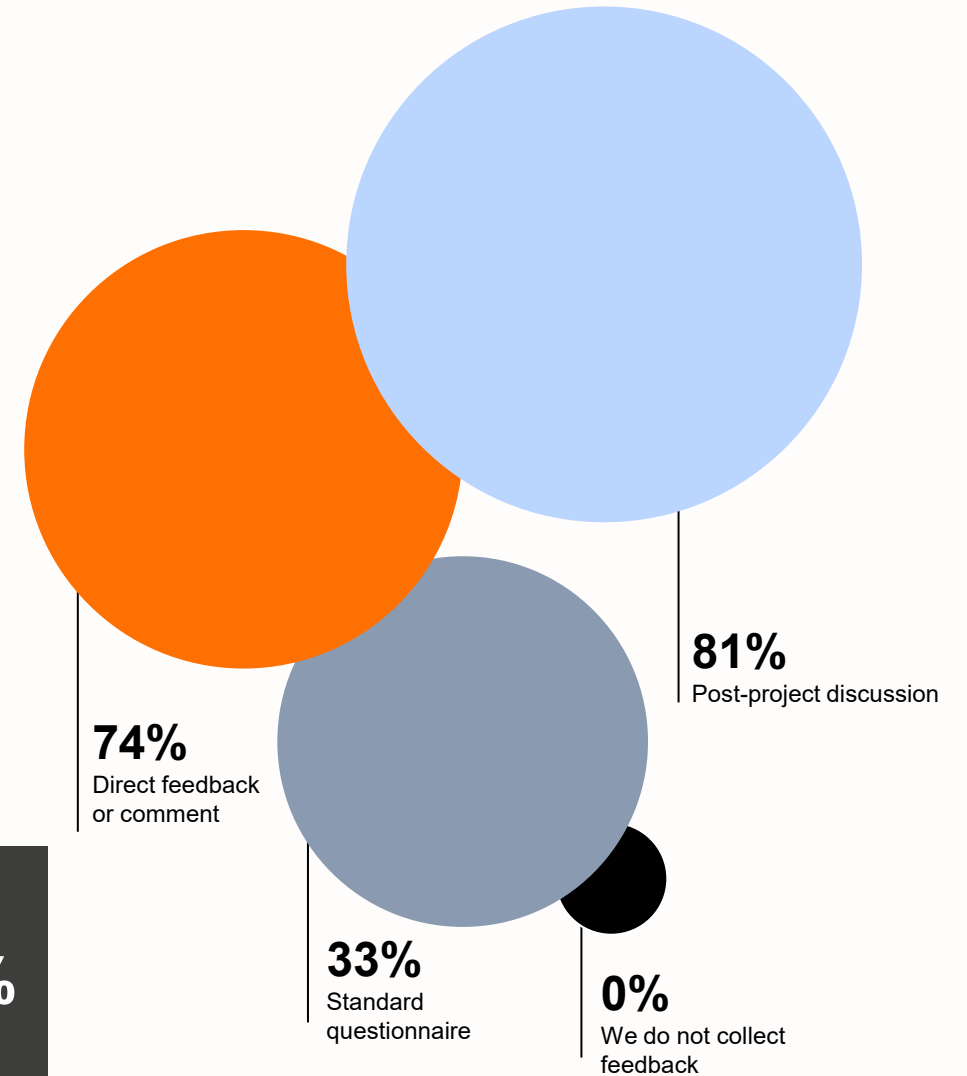
The KPI Gap

74% 74% of clients say they already track KPIs or have just started doing so

83% 83% say it's important or essential for them to collect data from their events (7+ on 10-point scale)

The KPI Gap

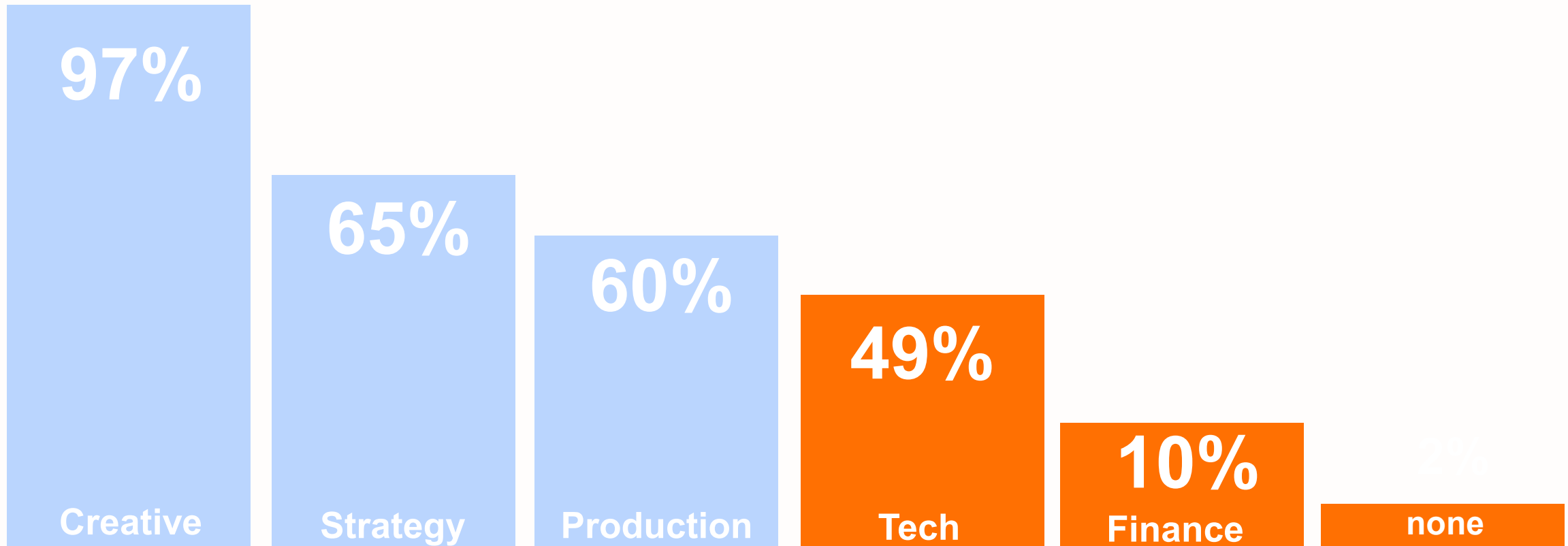
74% of feedback is gathered through informal discussions vs. only 33% in a standardized way



**WE EXPECT AI TO
DELIVER MIRACLES:
FASTER, CHEAPER,
BETTER- *IMMEDIATELY.***

AI / New Tech Fluency

AI is being actively leveraged across a spectrum of agency functions



AI / New Tech Fluency

84%

Meeting
New Suppliers

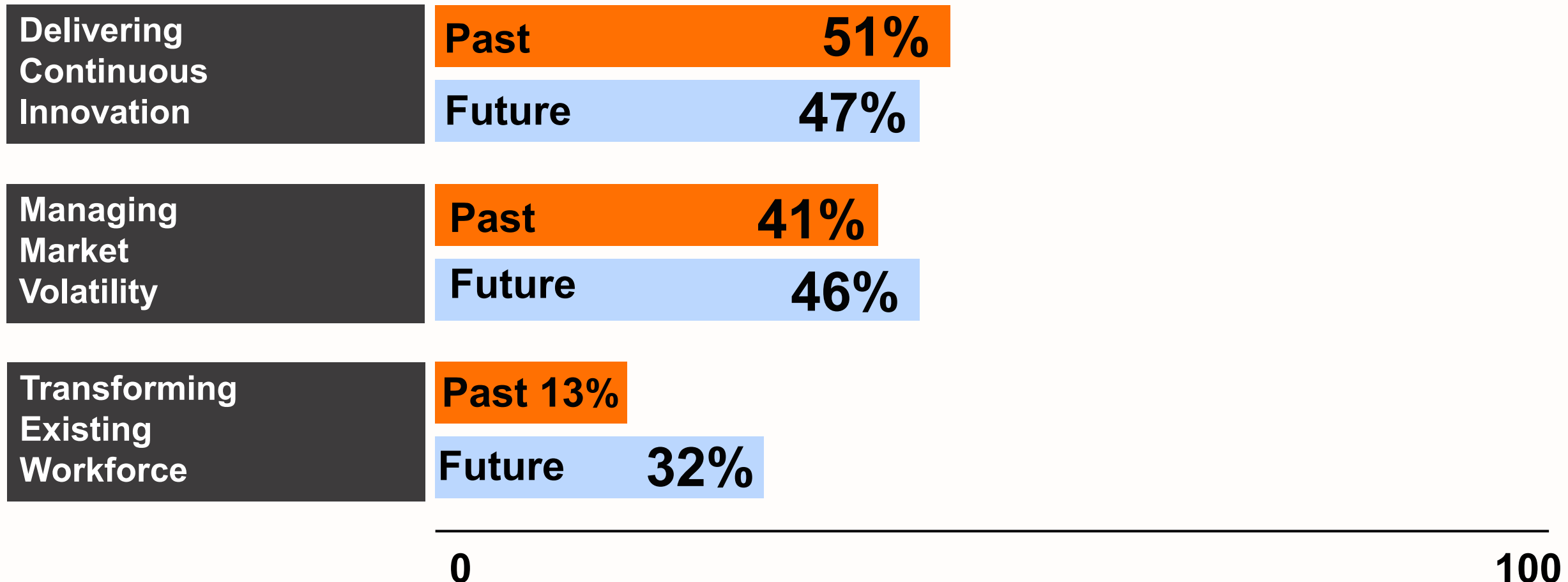
44%

Own
Innovation Teams

**Will in-house tech and innovation
teams become the new standard?**

**WE WANT INNOVATION *TODAY,*
BUT NEED WORKPLACE
TRANSFORMATION *TOMORROW.***

What Do Clients Really Want?



What Do Clients Really Want?

40%

**Purpose-Driven
Experiences**

37%

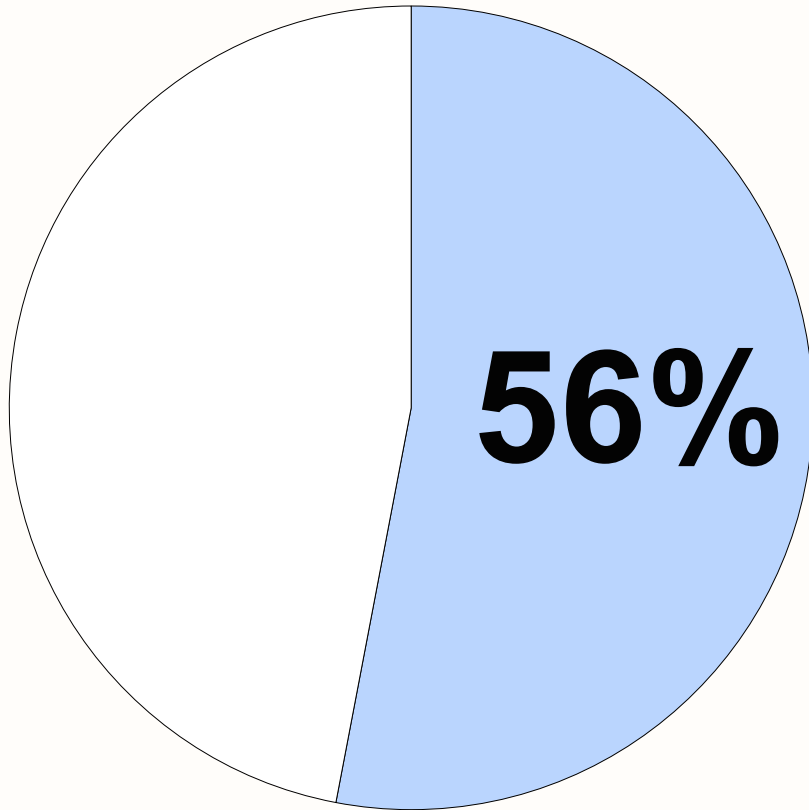
**Personalized
Experiences**

35%

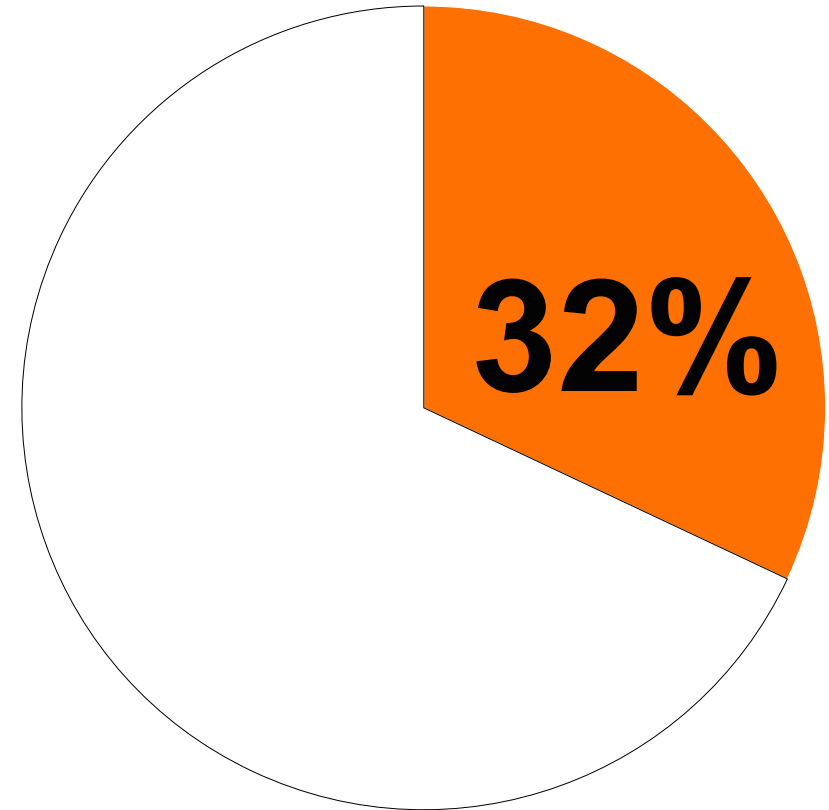
**Improved
Content**

**WE LOVE SUSTAINABILITY...
AS LONG AS *SOMEONE ELSE*
PAYS FOR IT.**

The Sustainability Reality Check



56% of agencies say that less than 50% of their clients and prospects are requesting sustainability credentials



32% of clients say they request these

The Sustainability Reality Check

Metric	Network Average
> 50% of clients expect sustainability credentials	42.9%
> 50% of clients willing to accept higher costs	12.7%
The Funding Gap	-30.2 pts

**WE ASK FOR MORE *CREATIVITY*
BUT WE ARE REALLY
INTERESTED IN *SAFETY*.**

The Pitch Paradox

52%

Agencies think creative excellence is the most important criteria

42%

Clients say it's the full service approach

18%

And clients don't score creative services very high...

The Pitch Paradox

59% Attendee experience
AT the event

42% Attendee experience
BEFORE the event

24% Branding

20% Content

**ACROSS 27 COUNTRIES, THE
DETAILS VARY, BUT THE STORY
WE SHARE IS SURPRISINGLY
*THE SAME.***

What Matters Most to Marketers in Different European Regions

UK and Ireland

45% vs 29%

Effectiveness ranks number one among all communication aspects for the English-speaking countries. 45% of Marketers in the UK and Ireland put it there, whereas the European client average is only at 29%.

Southern Europe

60% vs 27%

The thirst for first in live events is highest in Southern Europe. Clients anticipate that attendees at their events want the unseen and unheard experience. 60% of clients from those countries put it on rank #1 compared to just 27% as the European average.

Nordics

24% vs 18%

Clients from the Nordics believe in steady, continuous relationships more than their colleagues across Europe: 24% say they have long-term (3 years or more) service agreements with their event agencies in place. This is 33% higher than the average of 18%.

Central & Eastern Europe

64% vs 48%

Marketers in Central and Eastern Europe are well advanced on measuring the success of their live events with clear KPIs. 64% have established KPIs already which compares to the European average of 48%.

DACH

56% vs 40%

Purpose driven experiences are important to the audiences in the DACH (Germany, Austria, Switzerland) region where German is spoken. That's what 56% of clients believe is the number one audience need compared to 40% as the European average.

Baltics

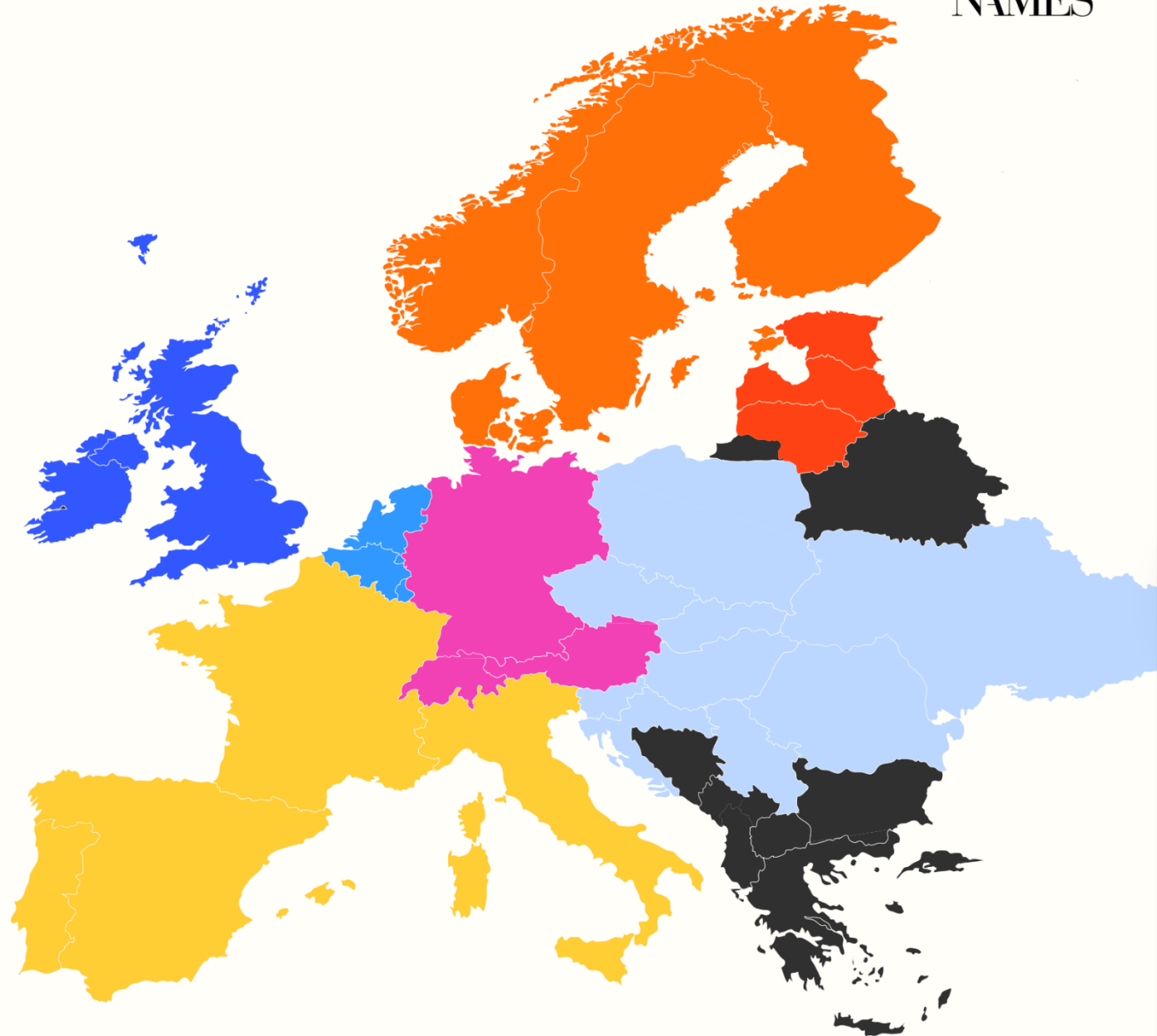
57% vs 37%

Digital competencies are strong in the Baltics. It is no wonder that personalization ranks equally high. Clients see it as the number 1 need of their audiences with 57% agreement compared to the European average of 37%.

BeNeLux

78% vs 47%

78% of the BeNeLux clients tick the top 3 boxes on a scale from 1 to 10 re: the importance of data analytics. 78% click on 8, 9 or 10 on that scale – the European average is 47%. That is significant and underlines the importance of data at this day and age.



SO WHAT ARE WE
***DOING* ABOUT IT?**

CASE STUDY

Magic Garden (FR): *Putting EEX insights to work*

1. Impact on client & partner activations

- W.I.N. Event (Dec 2025)
- Heavent Cannes (Mar 2026)
- Client Newsletter (May 2026)

→ EEX became a tool to add value to client relationships

2. Impact on agency strategy

- Agency's narrative & positioning
- Sharpened the **ROI and value of live experiences**
- Reinforced a **performance and impact-driven** approach

→ EEX provided the European benchmark to speak more strategically

magic garden
EVENT & NARRATIVE AGENCY

W.I.N. what is next
PARTIE 1

S'INSPIRER. ÉCHANGER. CO-CRÉER.
LES ÉVÉNEMENTS D'AUJOURD'HUI ET DE DEMAIN.

L'ÉVÉNEMENT EST MORT. VIVE L'ÉVÉNEMENT.

Et si les règles du jeu de notre métier avaient changé sans qu'on s'en rende vraiment compte ? Cette année, à travers le réseau 27Names dont Magic Garden est membre co-fondateur, nous avons décidé de prendre le pouls de l'événementiel en Europe.

Au total : 27 pays et près de 200 décideurs. Agences et marques réunies pour la première fois dans une même étude. Un regard croisé et une double perspective pour une vision sans filtre du marché.

C'est l'enjeu de cette première étude européenne : l'**'European Experience Index'™ (EEX) 2025**. Proposer un état des lieux à travers un baromètre mais surtout, un guide pour l'avenir de notre secteur.

Le résultat : 96 pages de données, d'analyses et de signaux faibles qui dessinent les nouvelles règles de l'expérience live. Des tensions, des contradictions, mais aussi de vraies opportunités.

Aujourd'hui, on vous partage l'essentiel. Ce qui change dans notre métier. Mais surtout, ce que ça change pour vous.

Bienvenue dans une nouvelle ère de l'événement. Partie 1.

KPI CRASH TEST – ENTRE BESOIN ET RÉALITÉ

Et si on arrêta de "mesurer"... pour vraiment piloter ? Aujourd'hui, tout le monde parle de performance.

74%
des marques déclarent déjà suivre leurs KPI, ou être en train de s'y mettre.

83%
considèrent même la data événementielle comme un enjeu clé. Sur le papier, tout est en place. Mais dans les faits ?

74%
des feedbacks restent informels

Seulement 33%
sont réellement structurés

CASE STUDY

VO (BE): Measuring What Matters *with* my impact tool

VO Group created **My Impact Tool (MIT)**, a platform to measure and improve the environmental and social performance of events and communication campaigns.

Some Highlights:

-  4 environmental dimensions measured
-  42% reduction in CO₂ emissions
-  Integrated into ESG strategy

VO Group moved **from awareness to accountability** - turning sustainability from a commitment into a **measurable, reportable** practice.

Full benchmark report on sustainability in events in Europe has been published.



CASE STUDY

Next Group (IT): Launching the *AI Transformation Journey*

Next Group launched a company-wide initiative to integrate AI into all aspects of the business.

Why This Matters

This is not just about efficiency, it's about freeing people to focus on what truly matters: **creativity, relationships, and strategic thinking.**

The Approach

01 — Listen & Discover

Dedicated workshops with every team

02 — Explore & Evaluate

Assess the best AI tools that can deliver immediate value

03 — Build & Innovate

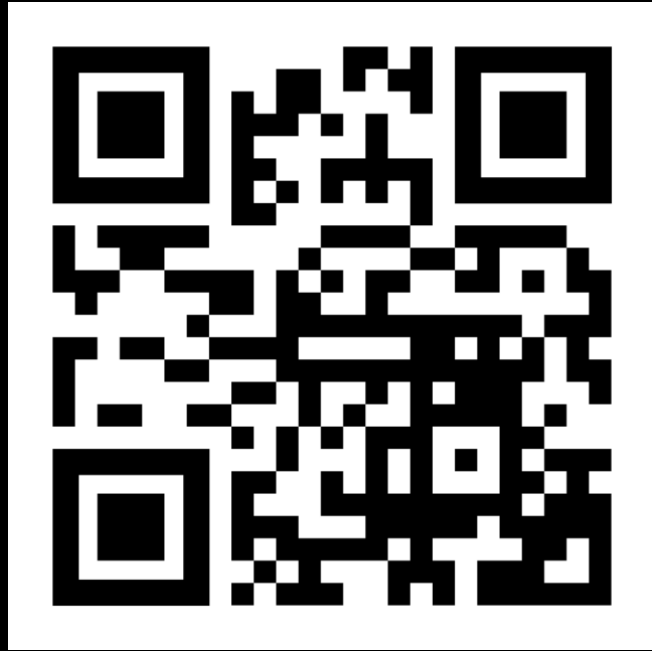
Identify tools tailored to the agency's needs to develop

04 — Train & Embed

Invest in hands-on training to build AI literacy



**DOWNLOAD THE
2025 REPORT**



**GET INVOLVED IN
THE 2026 SURVEY**





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**Thank
you!**